

90.2 DROPPING THE ENTIRE INFINITIVE CLAUSE

The entire infinitive clause can be dropped, or “to” can be kept on its own after some verbs, such as “agree,” “ask,” “forget,” “promise,” “start,” and “try.”



Chris is going to come to the show. He { **promised** [to come].
promised to [come].

The same structure can also be used after some nouns, such as: “chance,” “plans,” “promise,” “idea,” and “opportunity.”

I haven't seen this band before. I'd love the { **chance** [to see them].
chance to [see them].

The same structure can also be used after certain adjectives, such as “delighted,” “afraid,” “willing,” and “determined.”

I want to perform on stage, but I'm { **afraid** [to perform on stage].
afraid to [perform on stage].

FURTHER EXAMPLES

We need to leave soon, but I'm not **ready**.



I would travel the world if I had the **money**.



I want to go out, but I haven't got any **plans**.



I would never do a bungee jump. I don't have the **courage**.



They told me I could join the team if I **wanted to**.



I'm going to pass my driving test. I'm **determined to**.



Remind me to lock the door, or I'll **forget to**.



Thanks for asking me to come to your wedding. I'd **love to**.

